

FAST 4+1 B.A./M.A. roadmap: both degrees in five years

First-year entry, ten semesters · Graduate Coordinator: Inés Thiebaut, ines.thiebaut@csueastbay.edu, (510) 885-3126

This roadmap
online

Degrees	Entry	Total	Catalog
B.A. and M.A. in Music	First-year	120 + 32 units, 11 shared	2027–2028

01 Degrees at a glance

Degree	Units
B.A. in Music	120
M.A. in Music	32
Units counting toward both degrees	11
Units taken across the five years	141

Blended graduate coursework replaces part of the B.A. music electives. The music electives list is on the B.A. roadmap.

02 How the years run

The first three years follow the B.A. roadmap. You apply to FAST in the junior year. The fourth year runs the last of the B.A. alongside the first two semesters of the M.A., and the fifth year is graduate study only.

M.A. emphases are Performance (Classical or Jazz), Choral Conducting, and Composition. The GE courses shown are one typical selection: build your own GE plan with your advisor.

String players take Chamber Orchestra (MUS 365) as their Major Performing Ensemble.

03 Semester by semester

☐ Music
 ☐ General education
 ☐ Free elective
 ☐ Counts toward both degrees

Lower division

First semester (fall)

Course	Title	Units
ENGL 100	College Writing: Stretch I	3
ENGL 109	College Writing Lab	1
ES 121	People's History I	3
HIST 110	United States to 1877	3
MUS 108	The Language of Music	3
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study (placement audition)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		15

Second semester (spring)

Course	Title	Units
ENGL 101	College Writing: Stretch II	2
ENGL 109	College Writing Lab	1
COMM 100	Oral Communication	3
MATH 118E	Mathematics for the Arts and Humanities	4
MUS 111	Music Theory I	2
MUS 115	Aural Skills I	1
MUS 118	Keyboard Musicianship I	1
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		16

Third semester (fall)

Course	Title	Units
PHIL 100	Critical Thinking	3
GE 3B	Humanities	3
GE 5A	Physical and Biological Sciences	3
MUS 112	Music Theory II	2
MUS 116	Aural Skills II	1
MUS 119	Keyboard Musicianship II	1
MUS 381	Essentials of Music Technology	3
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		18

Upper division

Fifth semester (fall)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 4	Upper-division Social and Behavioral Sciences	3
MUS 323	Topics in Western Music History	3
MUS 312	Form and Analysis	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Music electives	4
Semester total		15

Blended year: the last of the B.A. alongside the first of the M.A.

Seventh semester (fall) • M.A. first semester

Course	Title	Units
MUS 304	World Music & Culture	3
MUS 360–369	Chamber Ensemble	1
	Free electives	3
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study (jury)	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 601	Analysis of Musical Styles: Birth and Death of Tonality	2
MUS 603	Entrepreneurship in the Arts	3
	Counts toward the B.A.	15
	Counts toward the M.A.	8
Semester total		15

Graduate year

M.A. third semester (fall)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 602	Analysis of Musical Styles: Post-Tonality and Beyond	2
MUS 630	Advanced Conducting	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 2 of 3	1
Semester total		8

Fourth semester (spring)

Course	Title	Units
GE 5B–C	Physical and Biological Sciences with lab	4
GE 6	Ethnic Studies	3
MUS 202	Writing About Music	3
MUS 211	Music Theory III	2
MUS 215	Aural Skills III	1
MUS 218	Keyboard Musicianship III	1
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		16

Sixth semester (spring)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 5	Upper-division Science and Quantitative Reasoning	3
UWR	University Writing Requirement	3
MUS 324	History of American Music	3
MUS 410	20th and 21st C Styles and Techniques	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		14

Apply to FAST during this semester.

Eighth semester (spring) • M.A. second semester

Course	Title	Units
	Free electives	8
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study (jury)	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 606	Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Music	2
MUS 605	History and Theory of Jazz	2
MUS 693	Capstone, 1 of 3	1
	Counts toward the B.A.	11
	Counts toward the M.A.	8
Semester total		16

The B.A. is complete at 120 units.

M.A. fourth semester (spring)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 631	Teaching Music in Higher Education	2
MUS 604	Sounding Justice: Unveiling the Ecological and Social Dimensions of Music	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 3 of 3	1
Semester total		8

The M.A. is complete at 32 units.